Local Social Network — MVP Requirements

Compiled from discovery research (`product-discovery/`) and a requirements interview conducted with Claude on 2026-09-16. This is the shared spec for the first buildable version of the app.

1. Who it's for and the problem

A local social network for discovering and organizing activities, launching in Rosenheim, Bavaria (roughly a 50–100km radius, occasionally extending to München). The seed community is "Vegans of Rosenheim" (vr), currently coordinated through a WhatsApp Community, but the concept isn't vr-exclusive — interviewees also follow other local organizers (Asta, Katzentempel, Straight, RosenheimWasGeht).

The core problem, drawn from five user interviews: WhatsApp works "well enough" today but causes information overload and spam, buries message history from new members, has no thread cohesion, poor group search/overview, and no reliable way to see or control who's attending an activity — which matters because several interviewees raised real safety concerns (stalking, unwanted people, feeling unsafe in unfamiliar groups). Organizers also carry a disproportionate moderation burden.

What people want: an easy way to discover activities, low-friction creation for organizers, a reliable commitment mechanism (request/accept), visibility into who's participating, and non-spammy notifications. What they explicitly don't want: aggressive ads, AI-generated "slop" or low-quality recommendations, and having to hand over a phone number.

2. MVP scope

In scope — 5 core features

1. Creating activities
2. Seeing activities (a single feed)
3. Creating a user profile
4. Requesting to join an activity
5. Accepting participants into your own activity

Explicitly out of scope for MVP (deferred to later versions)

- **Events** — the MVP covers Activities only; Events (with multi-organizer support) is a later version.
- **Chat / messaging** between users.
- **Google Calendar export.**
- **Social login** — email/password auth only.
- **Filters or search** on the activity list — everything is shown, unfiltered, since launch is Rosenheim-only (no location filtering needed yet).
- **Participant cap** on activities.
- **Removing an already-accepted participant** — organizers can decline pending requests, but cannot force-remove someone who was already accepted.

- **Blocking / reporting users** — a real safety concern from the interviews, and listed in the original value proposition canvas, but intentionally placed in the "Next" roadmap bucket rather than MVP. The only safety control in MVP is the organizer's ability to decline join requests.
- **Spam protection / rate limiting** — also deferred to a later version.

3. Data model

Activity

Field	Notes
Summary (Title)	
What to expect (Description)	
Organizer	relation → User (the creator)
Notice from Organizer	free text
Participants	relation → Participation (see below)
Date	
Meeting Time	not recurring in MVP — single fixed date/time
Location/Area	plain text in MVP, no geocoordinates
Meeting Location	plain text; **visible only to accepted participants** — needs field-level access control, not just record-level
Participants must be accepted (checkbox)	per-activity toggle between manual acceptance and auto-join

No participant cap in MVP.

Editing: always possible. As long as nobody other than the organizer participates, an edit is silent: there is no change message field and no notification. Once at least one other person participates, an edit triggers an "activity changed" push notification plus a **mandatory** (but unvalidated) message from the organizer, which is shown in the activity's details view.

Cancelling: a single "Cancel" action — **soft delete**, not a separate hard delete. Triggers an "activity cancelled" push notification plus a **mandatory** cancellation message. The cancelled activity disappears from the main chronological feed but stays reachable (badged "Cancelled") in a participant's own activity list/history, with the cancellation message visible in its details — so someone who missed the push notification can still find out why. This is not treated as a GDPR erasure case (that right applies to a user's own personal data, handled separately at the account level, likely via anonymizing rather than cascading deletes).

Participation (join request)

Represents one user's relationship to one activity. Requesting to join is a plain one-tap action with no message, and the action is only available from the activity's **detail** screen, not from the list.

State machine:

- `requested` (pending) — created when a user taps request.

- Requester can **revoke** their own pending request before the organizer decides → **hard deleted**, user can request again immediately.
- Organizer can **accept** or **decline** a pending request; declining may include a short optional message → **declined is soft-deleted**, and the user is **permanently blocked from requesting again** for that activity.
- Once **accepted**, the participant can **cancel** (leave) at any time, optionally with a message → **soft-deleted**, and the user **can request again**, going through the normal request flow (including approval, if required) as if for the first time.
- Organizer **cannot** force-remove an already-accepted participant in MVP.

So retention is soft-delete by default, with one deliberate exception (revoke → hard delete, to allow immediate clean re-requesting).

User

Field	Notes
Avatar	optional
Name	mandatory
Auth	email/password only, no social login in MVP
Short Bio	

Profile is **public** — visible to everyone in the MVP.

Activity list / discovery

- Single chronological list, no filters, no search.
- Activities the current user is accepted into are tagged "You're in".
- Grouped by date with sticky headers: within the current week, header shows weekday only; beyond that, weekday + date, plus the day-of-month for orientation. (Visual design to be provided separately.)

4. Notifications

Push notifications are in scope for MVP, limited to four triggers:

1. "You're in" — a join request that required acceptance gets accepted.
2. "Someone wants to join your activity" — notifies the organizer of a new join request.
3. "Activity cancelled" — organizer cancelled the activity; includes the mandatory cancellation message.
4. "Activity changed" — organizer edited an activity that at least one other person participates in; includes the mandatory change message.

5. Security & infrastructure

- **Tech stack:** Compose Multiplatform (Android + Web), Supabase backend.
- **Starting from scratch** — no Supabase project or Firebase project exists yet; both will be created with guidance during implementation. Firebase/FCM is needed for push notification delivery on Android and web.
- **Security defaults for MVP** (no additional requirements beyond this):
- Supabase Row Level Security restricting writes to a user's own data (edit/cancel only your own activities; accept/decline only requests on activities you organize).

- Meeting Location field hidden from anyone who isn't an accepted participant, via RLS or a view.
- Push notification dispatch happens server-side (a Supabase Edge Function), so FCM service credentials never reach the client.
- No rate limiting / spam protection in MVP — explicitly deferred.

6. Roadmap note ("Next" bucket, post-MVP)

- Events (multi-organizer support)
- Blocking / reporting users
- Spam protection / rate limiting
- (Chat, calendar export, social login, filters/search, participant caps were not explicitly placed on a roadmap bucket during this discovery — revisit if/when relevant.)

Business Model Canvas

Business Model Canvas (source: Strategyzer AG, CC BY-SA 3.0) with an add-on for eco-social costs and benefits. The numbers show the order in which the blocks were filled in.

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1. Customer Segments

- Event organisers
- People looking for friends
- Cities
- People looking for activities
- NGOs
- Activists

2. Value Proposition

- **For event organisers:** Finding participants for events.
- **For people looking for friends:** Open activities to connect to people with the same interests.
- **For activists:** Overview to activities by NGOs.
- **For people looking for activities:** Safe, spontaneous local community discovery without social media noise.
- **For cities:** Increase the life quality for citizens through more accessible activities.
- **For NGOs:** Direct access to highly engaged local volunteers and impact-oriented citizens.

3. Customer Relationships

- Events & activities they are interacting with
- Promotion by marketing channels
- Call-to-action by social media / recommendations

4. Channels

- App / app store
- Push notifications
- Social media / website
- On-site / recommendation

5. Key Activities

- Event partners onboarding
- Marketing
- Software development lifecycle
- Community moderation
- AI model prompt configuration and evaluation

6. Key Resources

- Backend
- App
- Event source
- AI agent

7. Key Partners

- NGOs
- Cities
- Locations / local venues / local businesses
- Event organisers
- Local universities / student groups
- Google Play / Apple App Store
- Development tools providers (IDE, libraries, GitHub, etc.)

8. Revenue Streams

- **Personal investment** (for app store fees and initial development costs)
- **Funding / donation** for further development, moderation, marketing
- **B2B** (NGOs / cities / commercial events) for marketing
- **Promoted events** if user base is large enough for operational costs
- **B2C** freemium / premium features
- Decent / integrated in-app ads for local businesses

> Note on the slide: *Doubts about that, just as a plan B if other streams fail.* It sits next to the B2C and in-app ads streams.

9. Cost Structure

- App store fee
- Development costs (MVP within project)
- Further development costs
- Moderation costs
- Marketing costs
- Hosting / domain costs
- Operational costs LLM API
- Note: if the user base is large enough to reach the free use limit
- Operational costs backend

Add-On

11. Eco-Social Costs and Ethical Risks

Risk	**Counter measure**
AI has hidden environmental costs	Green hosting?

Risk	Counter measure
Exploitation of loneliness / indirect pressure to use the app	-
Social problems might not be preventable like stalking, mobbing	Safety and usage guidelines and maybe AI-assisted detection
Misuse for unethical events	-

10. Eco-Social Benefits and Positive Impact

- Building social bridges
- Enhance impact of NGOs
- Fight populism and prejudice by cross-bubble community building
- Fight social isolation
- Enhance life quality of users

Context Analysis

Jobs-to-be-done style context analysis that led to the value proposition canvas. It has four steps (context, struggle, new solution, progress), followed by personas.

1. Context

Question	Answer
Who?	Someone looking for friends/activities
When?	Usually after work or at weekends, but can be along the day
When?	Without plans
Where?	At home or on the go
What?	Finding events/activities/managing free time
What?	Meet (new) people
Time constraint	Limited, quick check, spontaneous

2. Struggle: What changed?

What triggers a person to look for a new solution. The pink notes on the slide group the triggers into categories.

Intrinsic motivation to find activities and new people just got big enough

- Really bored
- Excited to meet new people

Change of life situation

- Moved to a new town
- Loneliness / feeling of isolation
- Break-up or loss of a friend circle

(Spontaneous) idea or suggestion

- Suggestion or social media post about the app
- Want to find people for an own event/activity
- Wish for experiences
- Inspired to bring people together

Bad experience on current solution to find events & meet people

- Current solution forced to spend time with unwanted people
- Spammed on chat solution
- Spammed on an event chat
- No replies on current solution

- Annoyed that no date could be found for a meeting

Not grouped on the slide

- Unsuccessful search for activities for a long time
- Missed an exciting event / friend's activity
- Meeting locals as a city tourist

3. The new solution

Positive characteristics

- Availability, easy to look up events & activities
- Organize own activities
- Choice of regular events and user created activities
- Notification on activities by friends

What is attractive?

- Flexible and spontaneous free-time spending
- Meeting new people
- Don't miss opportunities
- No frustrating long search
- No overload of events of no interest
- Activity first. No need to find people first.
- Quick commitment, no scheduling required
- Select people who join the activity
- No share-pic needed for events / less effort to organize
- Feed invited to other people's activities
- Allow to accept participants for activities

4. Progress: When is the new solution better? What goals are behind it?

Functional	**Emotional / Social**
Overview of activities	Feeling active / outgoing / proud
Easy attendance	Having fun
Spontaneous activities	Feeling independent
Search / filter / recommendations	Feeling invited / connected / fitting in
Push notifications to not miss events by friends and followed organisations	Excitement looking what's up
See participants	Having an impact of bringing people together

Personas

Persona	Description	"If I..."	"...help me..."
Persona A	Very active in her free time, loves meeting new people	...am looking for new experiences	...organise or find activities to have a memorable time and learn new points of view
Persona B	New in town / relationship ended, actively looking for friends	...am interested in new connections	...get to know new people to build a new friend circle or share common interests
Persona C	Wants occasionally to see what's up if they are bored	...am bored	...see what my friends are up to or where I am invited to join in to have a fun and meaningful time
Persona D	Political / social active	...feel the need to bring people together	...find people for my events so that I can have an impact with my events

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Source slides

Glossary

Term	Definition
Activity	A planned social activity or gathering that users can discover or organize.
Colibri	A WhatsApp community to connect activits and NGOs. (not yet active as of August 2026)
Event	A pubic event that users can attent. Can require a RSVP
Location	A physical place (bar, park, gym) where events take place.
Organizer	A person or entity responsible for planning and hosting an event.
RSVP	A request to confirm the attendance to an event or activity (Respondez-sil-vous-plait)
User	A person that uses the local social network.
Vegans of Rosenheim	A local NGO in Rosenheim that provides events and a Community plattform for activities.
vr	The abbreviation for "Vegans of Rosenheim".

Ideas for Later

Ideas noted for later. They are not requirements and not yet part of the roadmap.

Make friend requests meaningful

Only allow adding a friend if:

1. the users participated in the same activity/event, or
2. the user was added as a friend by a shared link.

This would prevent the follow/friend requests seen on Instagram/Facebook and focus on local friends.

Related roadmap item: "Manage friends" (Later).

Source slide

Hypothesis and Assumption Mapping

Lean product management exercise. Hypotheses are grouped by desirability, feasibility and viability, then placed on an assumption map ("We believe that…").

Hypotheses

Desirability (need)

Hypotheses concerning need and user base.

- Users will install a new event/social network app.
- Users will use the app to create activities.
- Users will regularly open the app to check upcoming events.
- Event organisers will share their events within the app.
- The last three together lead to: *there will be enough content in the app to keep users engaged.*
- Users will join activities with people they don't know yet.
- Users are staying on the app even when they have a stable social circle.
- Users will invite around 2-5 friends to the app to organize activities.
- Users are going to events & activities where they RSVPed.

Feasibility (implementability)

Hypotheses that concern technical, legal and content-related feasibility and regulatory requirements.

- A MVP can be created in 4 weeks of development.
- The web application can be created despite deeper knowledge. *(sic; wording as on the slide)*
- Events from other sources can be imported into the data source.
- AI API calls can be done in a way to have matching recommendations.
- AI API calls do not expose personal user data.

Viability (economic viability)

Hypotheses concerning the market, economic potential and finances.

- Agentic APIs can be used without costs in a scope that allows users to get event recommendations.
- Further development costs can be carried by fundings (crowd & city).
- Partners (cities/locations/NGOs) will use the app as a source for their events.
- The backend can be hosted freely by a BaaS provider.
- If the user base is big enough to have hosting and AI costs, event organizers are willing to pay a small fee to promote their events.

Assumption map

Axes: **importance for our undertaking** (critical ↔ unimportant) and **certainty** that the hypothesis applies (uncertain ↔ certain).

Quadrant	Importance / certainty	Hypotheses
Evaluate (investigate)	critical, uncertain	**Users will install a new event/social network app** (highlighted) **There will be enough content in the app to keep users engaged** (highlighted; supported by the three notes below) **Partners will use the app as a source for their events** (highlighted) Users will regularly open the app to check upcoming events Event organisers will create their events within the app Users will use the app to create activities (WhatsApp evidence)
Plan (approach)	critical, certain	AI API calls do not expose personal user data Users are going to events & activities where they RSVPed (WhatsApp evidence) Users will join activities with people they don't know yet (WhatsApp evidence) Events from other sources can be imported into the data source
Generate (discover)	unimportant, uncertain	Further development costs can be carried by fundings (crowd & city) Users are staying on the app even when they have a stable social circle Users will invite around 2-5 friends to the app to organize activities If the user base is big enough, event organizers are willing to pay a small fee to promote their events AI API calls can be done in a way to have matching recommendations Agentic APIs can be used without costs in a scope that allows event recommendations
Defer (postpone)	unimportant, certain	A MVP can be created in 4 weeks of development The backend can be hosted freely by a BaaS provider The web application can be created despite deeper knowledge (on the boundary to *Generate*)

Evidence note

The author already hosts a WhatsApp community that allows people to meet new people, share events and start own activities. This works as a running Concierge Test and gives higher certainty for some assumptions. Hypotheses backed by it carry a WhatsApp mark on the map.

Takeaways

- The riskiest critical unknowns (**Evaluate**) are the need for a new app, enough content to keep users engaged, and partner adoption. This matches the challenge noted in the problem-framing canvas: "finding users".

- Privacy of AI calls is critical and considered certain. See the risk register for the mitigation (anonymous requests, no access to the full database).

Source slides

Test Cards

Possible tests for later, derived from the critical, uncertain hypotheses in the assumption map (quadrant *Evaluate*).

1. Users will install a new event/social network app

Step	Content
Hypothesis	We believe that users will install a new event/social network app.
Test	For the test we will create an e-mail waiting list and share it in social media and our WhatsApp community.
Measurement	And measure how many users are willing to join.
Criteria	And are correct when more than 10 participants want to join.

Note: The WhatsApp community with its 200 participants is already sufficient for an active community with weekly events, but only 5% of future users are expected to be willing to subscribe to a waiting list.

2. There will be enough content in the app to keep users engaged

Step	Content
Hypothesis	We believe that there will be enough content in the app to keep users engaged.
Test	To test, we will take record of activities shared in the WhatsApp community by users within three weeks.
Measurement	And measure the number of suggested activities, successful activities and interaction score.
Criteria	And are correct when there are more than 1-2 weekly activity requests, more than 1 successful weekly activity and more than 4 reactions/messages per activity on average.

3. Partners will use the app as a source for their events

Step	Content
Hypothesis	We believe that partners (cities/locations/NGOs) will use the app as a source for their events.
Test	To test, we will make contact with 16 event providers / locations / institutions / NGOs and ask them if they are willing to share their events within the app right away.
Measurement	And measure the number of participants to agree.

Step	Content
Criteria	And are correct when more than 3 partners with weekly events and more than 1 partner with special events are willing to share their events.

Note: 3 partners with weekly events might also prevent an "empty app syndrome".

Selection of partners in Rosenheim

Weekly events:

- Stadt Rosenheim
- Asta
- Vetternwirtschaft
- Rosa Wohnzimmer
- BikeKitchen Rosenheim
- Vegans of Rosenheim
- RosenheimWasGeht
- Straight
- Jung & Taxler
- Midgard Taverne

Special events only:

- Tony's Burger
- Katzentempel
- LGBTQ+ Rosenheim
- Nerdiko
- Kettenöl & Konsens
- Zeug:innen der Flucht

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Legal and Ethical Reality Check

Answers from the AI Software Engineering Bootcamp exercise on legal and ethical aspects of the project.

1. Which personal data is processed (directly or indirectly)?

- User data such as profile information (display name, avatar, age, additional information)
- Current geolocation
- Event related information (attendance, liked, organised events)
- Special category data (inferred by events, such as political opinions, religion and sexual orientation)

2. Who owns the generated output?

Assuming the terms of service of the used AI tools do not claim copyright:

- Purely functional code is probably not under copyright.
- Adapted domain logic is under copyright of the author or a later company if modifications are made.
- Adapted open source library code is under the same license as the original.
- Specific algorithms / solutions may be licensed by someone else and thus may not be used without verification.

In short: the author owns the code in terms of responsibility but may not have copyright on it.

3. What licenses apply?

Training data (if known): Probably unknown.

Generated code:

- Adapted open source library code is under the same license as the original.
- If purely functional, no licenses can be applied.
- Specific AI agents may apply licenses to generated output (terms of service must be checked).

4. Who is liable if the AI causes harm?

The vendor of the app (the author or a later company).

5. What would a regulator or lawyer ask first?

- Is personal data handed to third parties, and is it mentioned in the GDPR contract?
- Does the application comply with the EU AI Act? (Probably limited risk; AI interaction must be clearly marked.)
- Is the generated code reviewed by a human? (Regarding copyright violations)

Open risks

- Precise geodata is highly sensitive data.
- Source of generated code unknown.
- Generated code is not adapted enough and violates a license.
- Personal data passed to the AI agent cannot be controlled (e.g. deleted by the user).
- Prompt injection unveils data that should not be visible.

Assumptions

- Personal data is not passed to an AI agent. Instead, just available events and filter criteria (including the prompt) are passed, with no data that links the request to a specific user.
- Generated code is not owned by the AI company.
- The prompting within the application is clearly marked as using AI.
- The event recommendation is not seen as high risk according to the AI Act.

Unknowns

- What if personal data is prompted?

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Naming

Decision

The app is called **Wasn.jetzt** (domain: `wasn.jetzt`, secured). The name is already in use for the app.

The code-side project title stays **"Local Social Network"** (repository, modules, packages).

How the name was chosen

1. Names were collected in a brainstorming (below). The green notes were the shortlist.
2. A small survey was held between the two candidates **Streuner*in** and **Wasn.jetzt**.
3. **Wasn.jetzt** won the survey.

Brainstorming

Shortlist (green notes):

App name	Domain
ActLocal	actlocal.io
Streuner*in	streuner.in
Wasn?	wasn.jetzt

Other ideas (yellow notes):

- Loci
- Ortsteil
- BePart
- WasGehtHier
- mitmachen (domain: mitmachen.io)
- Stray
- Vagabond
- Word + animal, e.g. MeetRabbit, Local Cat

Discarded

- **ActLocal** was discarded because it sounds too "cold", "technical" and like activism. It was the working name earlier, so the stakeholder press release and FAQ still use it.

Logos

Both survey candidates had a logo draft: a cat with a map pin for Streuner*in (white on black), and a heart-shaped map pin with a question mark for Wasn.jetzt (white on turquoise).

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Cost and Scalability

Answers from the AI Software Engineering Bootcamp exercise on operational risks of the AI event recommendation.

Cost controls

- Use API rate limits.

Fallback strategies

- Fall back to a free model if the rate limit is exceeded.
- Fall back to a basic implementation like a simple search in event names and tags.
- On Android the local on-device model might be used.

Monitoring signals

- APIs might warn that a rate limit is about to be reached. This could result in a higher price tier if it is within a cost-benefit ratio.

Concrete questions

1. **What happens if usage suddenly increases 10×?** The rate limit will be reached, which should trigger the fallback.
2. **What happens if the API is down?** See fallback strategies.
3. **What's the cost per user / action?** Right now that's a big unknown. If the app is only published privately, a free model must be used.
4. **When does this become unsustainable?** When costs arise that cannot be funded, or if funding is done by advertised events, which are not visible to the AI recommendation.

Source slide

Risk Register

Operational risks of the AI event recommendation, from the AI Software Engineering Bootcamp exercise. See also legal-and-ethical-reality-check and cost-and-scalability.

Risk Category	Description of Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation / Decision
Trust & UX	Bugs in application	High	High	Prevent and detect by quality safeguards / review.
Model Behaviour	Insufficient event recommendations	High	Med	Prevent and detect by evals; fallback with clear AI label to inform users about possible hallucinations.
Model Behaviour	Biased or outdated data	High	Med	Prevent by making requests anonymous and setting data to actual events (e.g. by ids instead of generated text).
Data Protection & Privacy (GDPR)	Personal data is shared and cannot be controlled	High	High	Prevent by restricting access to data / making data anonymous.
Data Protection & Privacy (GDPR)	Prompt injection unveils events (e.g. for stalking)	High	High	Prevent by a fixed set of data to search from and include friends' attendance only if mutual. The agent gets no access to the full database.
Data Protection & Privacy (GDPR)	Geolocation of user is leaked	Med	High	Prevent by not using geolocation for the request, just the region. Use geolocation only locally to calculate distance to events.
Compliance / Regulation	Limited Risks requirements not met	Low	High	Prevent by marking the recommendation feature as AI.
IP & Licensing	Generated code violates license	High	High	Prevent and detect by review and by using an AI tool to scan for violations.
Cost & Scalability (API limits, usage spikes)	API rate limit exceeded or API is down	High	Med	Detect by error handling; fall back to another provider or manual search.

Source slide

Problem-Framing Canvas

Created for the practical project in the AI Software Engineering Bootcamp. It defines the intention of the project.

Idea

A local network to find events and activities.

Business Context

Present: What is the current status of this idea?

- Done similar by various approaches
- Challenge will be finding users
- Could be an open source solution for NGOs/cities

Past: How have we (or others) tried to solve the problem?

What worked well?

- Meet5
- Facebook Groups
- Websites

What didn't work so well?

- No way to follow institutions
- No separation between events and social media content
- No control about attendees
- No filtering of interests
- No collaboration across NGOs

Future

What are our competitors doing in this area?

- ? (not yet researched)

What trends work against or in favour of this idea?

- Against: online communication instead of real-life meetups
- In favour: people are looking for real-life connections

Where are the potential opportunities?

- Bringing people together
- Gain NGOs and cities as customers

Needs/Goals: What do we want to achieve?

- Motivating users to participate in real-life events
- Bringing people together (anti-polarization)
- Connect NGOs
- Finding users for events
- Suitable showcase for future employers across all industries

Customer Context

Present: Who are the customers, users or target group?

Who should we focus on first?

- People who are looking for activities nearby
- People who want to meet new people or find new friends

When/where do they need our solution? When do they encounter the most difficulties?

- At home looking for something to do
- Not knowing where to look
- Not knowing if welcome at a certain get-together

How do they currently solve their problems? What behaviours can we observe?

- Social media & other apps
- Google search
- Staying at home / social isolation

Past: What has the target group tried in the past?

What worked well? Contributing factors or alternative solutions?

- Following local social media channels
- Using WhatsApp Communities
- Using smaller apps like Meet5
- Using Google

What didn't work so well? What obstacles were there?

- No separation between events and social media content
- No search or notifications on certain topics or activities
- Unreliable event source or no complete overview
- Separate sources that need to be watched

Needs/Goals: Why would they need our solution?

- Meeting new people
- Find activities nearby

Future

What trends and changes could influence our customers/users/target group?

- Creating new peers
- Social media (breaks)
- Having a feeling of impact (for voluntary activities)

If nothing changes, what would the future look like for them?

- Social media chaos
- Increasing isolation
- Difficult activity search

Problem Statement

- **Our** target group of **social active people**
- **has the problem** of **finding activities**
- **if** they **want to meet new people**.
- **Our solution will** offer **finding activities nearby**
- **and also help our company** by **creating a platform for private users, NGOs and cities to find participants for events**.

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Detail blocks: idea, business present, business past, business future, business needs/goals, customer present, customer past, customer future, customer needs/goals, problem statement.

Agile Roadmap

Time-framing of features (Now / Next / Later) that leads to the MVP requirements. Each row is a feature group.

Feature group	Now	Next	Later
Activities & Events	Create a free-time activity See other users' free-time activities to join Join a free-time activity	Free-time activity participation with basic chat and meeting instructions See public events Create public events as organisation	Import events from external source
Security & User Management	Share user profile Control user participation at free-time activity	Report & block users	Manage friends Report events or activities
Suggestion & Notification	–	Get notifications for events and activities	Get recommendations for events by AI Filter activities and events by categories and attributes
Sharing	–	–	Invite external friends to app Invite in-app friends to activities Share events & app with external users

By time frame

Now (5)

- Create a free-time activity
- See other users' free-time activities to join
- Join a free-time activity
- Share user profile
- Control user participation at free-time activity

Next (5)

- Free-time activity participation with basic chat and meeting instructions
- See public events
- Create public events as organisation

- Report & block users
- Get notifications for events and activities

Later (8)

- Import events from external source
- Manage friends
- Report events or activities
- Get recommendations for events by AI
- Filter activities and events by categories and attributes
- Invite external friends to app
- Invite in-app friends to activities
- Share events & app with external users

Source slide

Stakeholder Management Responses

Responses to difficult stakeholder scenarios (cases) from the AI Software Engineering Bootcamp. Two cases were answered, as they are the most relevant for the project in the context of a collaboration with a city, where costs and regulation are most critical.

> **Note:** The figures in the responses (500 users, 15 paid integrations, 40% cost reduction, 90 and 120 days) are scenario assumptions made for the exercise. They are not validated numbers. See the hypothesis and assumption mapping for what is actually still to be tested.
>
> The case descriptions themselves (pink notes on the slide) were too small to read in the screenshot. From the responses, Case 1 is a cost-focused stakeholder who wants to cut expenses, and Case 5 is a legal / compliance stakeholder worried about data protection and algorithmic failure. *(Case descriptions to be completed.)*

Case 1: Cost-focused stakeholder

> "I understand the mandate to cut expenses. That is exactly why we designed ActLocal not as an expensive software bet, but as a controlled risk mitigation strategy."

The Cost of Not Building It

Doing nothing is an active financial liability. Right now, our local economy is losing foot traffic to global digital platforms that extract value without reinvesting locally. If we do not provide a digital utility to drive traffic to our local leisure economy, regional business tax revenues face a projected stagnation. Furthermore, building a traditional, non-AI platform later will cost us three times as much in manual content management and engineering hours. By utilizing advanced AI-development frameworks now, we have compressed our initial development cap-ex by 40%.

One Conservative Scenario

Our financial baseline does not rely on aggressive viral growth. In our conservative scenario, we project a modest cap of **500 active private users** and **15 paid commercial integrations** (restaurants/clubs) within the first six months. At a baseline subscription fee for automated API event synchronization, the platform covers its own operational and server costs within **90 days**. Any growth beyond that directly subsidizes our Smart City digital infrastructure, shifting the project from a cost center to a self-sustaining regional asset.

One Kill-Criterion

We are treating this strictly as an agile experiment, not a permanent line item. Our hard kill-criterion is commercial partner adoption: **If we do not secure 10 fully integrated, paying commercial stakeholders within 120 days of launch, we will immediately freeze development and sunset the platform.** This caps our maximum downside financial exposure to the initial setup budget, ensuring zero long-term budget bleeding.

Case 5: Legal / compliance stakeholder

> "You are entirely right. In a regional deployment backed by municipal stakeholders, a single data compliance or algorithmic failure could completely destroy public trust and expose us to severe regulatory liabilities. We treat your concerns as core system requirements, not roadblocks."

Here is how the architecture is built to protect the organization.

Clear Boundaries (What the Product Will NOT Do)

- **No black-box automated profiling:** The AI engine **will not** create permanent behavioral profiles or score users based on sensitive personal characteristics.
- **No unauthorized third-party data sharing:** User data **will never** be passed to external LLM providers or enterprise software conglomerates; all recommendation processing is strictly sandboxed within our localized, GDPR-compliant infrastructure.
- **No restricted access:** The system **will not** require personal data for discovery. Users can fully explore all public events without creating an account or providing any identifiable data.

Safeguards & Review Processes

- **Strict consent architecture:** Data matching for active community groups operates on an explicit, granular opt-in basis. Users retain full autonomy to view, modify, or permanently purge any interaction data passing through the AI recommendation engine.
- **Algorithmic guardrails:** We have implemented deterministic filters on top of the AI engine. This ensures the recommendation engine can only match predefined local interest tags (e.g., 'sports', 'cultural outings') and is structurally incapable of generating or interpreting unapproved, sensitive data categories.

Invitation to Co-Own Risk Decisions

We want to ensure your team has complete visibility before we go live. We invite you to **co-chair our launch readiness review**. Specifically, we would like to collaborate with you to define the exact thresholds for our automated user verification system.

Let's set up a 30-minute session next Tuesday to review the data-flow diagrams together and establish a permanent legal sign-off gate in our deployment pipeline.

Caution: responses vs. current plan

Parts of these responses are stronger than what the other knowledge-base documents state. They are persuasion texts for stakeholders, not specifications. Check the following before relying on them:

Claim in the response	Current state elsewhere in the knowledge base
User data is never passed to external LLM providers; all processing sandboxed in local infrastructure	The legal check and FAQ only commit to passing anonymous event data and filter criteria to an AI API; the AI API is external.
Users can view, modify or purge data passing through the AI engine	The legal check lists "personal data passed to the AI agent cannot be controlled (e.g. deleted by the user)" as an **open risk**.

Claim in the response	Current state elsewhere in the knowledge base
15 paid integrations / 10 paying partners, subscription fee	The business model canvas lists B2B as one revenue stream; the test card targets 3+ partners sharing events, not paying.
Automated user verification	Planned for the future (see press release roadmap), not part of the MVP.

Source slide

Press Release Local Social Network "ActLocal"

Stakeholder Press Release (translated and optimized version). German original: press-release.de.md

Rosenheim Pioneers AI-Driven Social Connection with the Launch of Local Network "ActLocal"

ROSENHEIM, GERMANY – March 1, 2027 – ActLocal, an innovative regional social network, has officially launched its platform in Rosenheim to foster community engagement and showcase the practical benefits of artificial intelligence. Available immediately across Web, Android, and iOS formats, the free platform bridges the gap between digital innovation and real-world social interaction, addressing the growing macroeconomic challenge of social isolation.

While traditional social media platforms often increase screen time, ActLocal utilizes a hybrid architecture to encourage offline activity. The platform features two core pillars: verified public event integration for local businesses and community-driven group activities. By providing integrated group chats, automated meeting points, and unique visual identifiers for attendees, the application ensures a frictionless onboarding process for individuals seeking to expand their local networks.

Strengthening the Regional Ecosystem and Smart City Initiatives

For municipal stakeholders, ActLocal serves as a benchmark project for regional digitalization. The application was built utilizing advanced AI-development frameworks and features an integrated AI-recommendation engine to optimize user engagement. This approach demonstrates how advanced technology can be democratized for public welfare rather than being restricted to enterprise software or major tech conglomerates.

"Enhancing the overall quality of life in Rosenheim has always been a core strategic priority," stated Abuzar Erdoan, Mayor of Rosenheim. "We are proud to support a project that demonstrates how artificial intelligence can be deployed responsibly to generate tangible social value that benefits our entire community."

High Initial Traction and Commercial Integration

At launch, the platform reports strong initial traction, with over **200 active private users** organizing regional activities such as sports, cultural outings, and networking meetups. Furthermore, local commercial stakeholders—including leading regional clubs, restaurants, and associations—have integrated their event calendars into the platform, driving immediate foot traffic to local businesses and stimulating the regional leisure economy.

Strategic Roadmap and Scalability

ActLocal's engineering team is focused on sustainable growth and platform security based on early deployment data.

"Our objective is to streamline leisure planning while maintaining the highest standards of user safety," said Alex Saalfeld, Product Engineer at ActLocal. The upcoming development roadmap includes automated user verification to build systemic trust, alongside scalable API interfaces to allow seamless automated event synchronization for commercial partners.

Users can explore public events without registration. Active participation in community groups requires a verified account, which can be created within minutes. For more information, visit the official platform at www.actlocal.io.

Source slide

Stakeholder FAQ

Questions that stakeholders would ask after reading the stakeholder press release, with the answers. Each question names the stakeholder lens it comes from.

1. Why do you believe this solution will work?

Stakeholder lens: investor / partners / analyst / press

The ActLocal app will work because it addresses a large and verified pain point in the everyday life of many people, such as loneliness, boredom, social isolation and insecurity.

With our WhatsApp community of over 200 participants we could already validate that there is a demand to create and join other users' activities as well as meeting new people. Other solutions like RosenheimWasGeht gained over 3000 followers in a couple of weeks just by sharing events in the area.

Though there is a large number of other apps already (also indicating a large market), there is a lack of combining event discovery with social engagement. Our solution will encourage participation in events, also creating a benefit for venues and associations to gain a larger audience.

2. What is the difference between your solution and existing ones?

Stakeholder lens: investor / partners / competitor

While there are already multiple solutions, there is no larger player that combines all aspects of ActLocal, such as activity focus, engagement, openness and participant control.

In our competitor check we identified the following major pain points:

Competitor	**Pain point**
Eventim, Rausgegangen, Meetup and other event providers	Do not focus on events to meet friends and lack the ability of user engagement.
Nebenan.de and other local social networks	Provide exchange but no activity-driven approach to meet new people.
Social media channels on Facebook, Instagram & Co.	Do not provide overview within the area and trap the user in endless scrolling.
WhatsApp Groups, Facebook Groups and other local groups	Cause message spam and hence frustration organising an activity.

So far, none of these solutions had participant control to prevent unpleasant encounters. In addition:

- **Facebook Events** cannot be restricted to social activities.
- **Bumble** requires you to find the friend first, causing complicated messaging to meet.
- **Meet5** exposes participants, causing inhibition when it comes to participation or organisation.

ActLocal not only prevents all these problems but also gives users an AI assistant to find exactly the events and activities they are interested in.

3. How can users prevent unpleasant encounters?

Stakeholder lens: journalist / ethics / public

User safety and trust are core pillars of ActLocal's design, directly addressing the prominent customer pains of safety risks like stalking and unpleasant encounters.

- **Participant control:** ActLocal lets organisers decide which registrations for activities they accept. For activities the user just attends, accepted users can see the other guests so that they can protect themselves from unwanted confrontations.
- **Activity onboarding:** Meeting point and group identification can be hidden until the guest is accepted.
- **User management:** By blocking users, activities will be hidden for unwanted persons.

4. How will you carry the costs for development and operation?

Stakeholder lens: investor / finance press

As our app has a charitable goal, we will apply for both crowd and governmental funding to ensure further development.

We expect operational costs only to appear with a large number of users, which will then open up the possibility for sponsoring and meaningful ads for local businesses within the app.

5. How can users control which data is passed to an AI agent?

Stakeholder lens: regulator / privacy advocate / enterprise buyer / journalist / ethics / public

The AI request is an opt-in for users explicitly using the "Suggestions by AI" prompt feature.

Still within this feature, we limit the data the LLM can see by only passing anonymous event data and search criteria. This way we prevent the model from knowing personal data about the user.

6. Why are you the right one for the job?

Stakeholder lens: investor / partners

There are two major reasons that make this project a perfect match:

- **Proven technical experience** in creating cross-platform apps, even with another local social network.
- **Deep user understanding** as part of the target group, organising events and attending activities with new people regularly.

Related

- Risk register and legal and ethical reality check for the background to questions 3 and 5.
- Cost and scalability for question 4.
- Business model canvas for the revenue streams mentioned in question 4.

Source slides

Tech Stack

#	Stack Layer	Choice	Why this choice?	Complexity	Status
1	Frontend Framework	Compose / Kotlin Multiplatform	Best choice after evaluation [^1]	High	Decided
2	Frontend Styling	Material 3 Expressive / (*Cupertino*)	Best practice for Android, spread in web. Cupertino (iOS style) may be added later.	Low	Decided
3	Backend	Supabase (BaaS)	Best choice after evaluation [^2]	Medium	Decided
4	Database Type	Supabase/PostgreSQL Room/SQLite (for local caching)	Geospatial support Default for Android	Medium	Decided
5	Database Hosting	Supabase	The easiest solution for a portfolio project, but can also be self-hosted later.	Medium	Decided
6	Auth Solution	Supabase	Easy to use API for e-mail, Google, Apple.	Low	Decided
7	IDE / AI Tool	Android Studio / Gemini (limited) Additionally Claude Code or Cursor	Best integration in Android build tools, limited for about 2-4 hours of productive use a day, can be extended by Claude from the CLI or by the Cursor IDE.	Medium	Researching
8	Additional Tool	Gradle, Lint	Default KMP build tool and code style check.	Medium	Decided

[^1]: Evaluation: Kotlin Multiplatform vs. React Native, see technology-evaluations. [^2]: Evaluation: Supabase vs. Firebase, see technology-evaluations.

Source slide

Technology Evaluations

Pro-arguments collected for the two main technology decisions in the tech stack.

1. Frontend framework: Kotlin Multiplatform (KMP) vs. React Native

Decision: Compose / Kotlin Multiplatform.

Option	Arguments
KMP	Known domain Better verification Favorite technology Android related Highest software quality Growing technology, increasing number of jobs Different path than web, so more direct learning impact Modularity / build time = ideal for AI
React Native	JavaScript job market Learn how to handle new technology with AI Better known for better AI results Probably easier to convert to KMP than otherwise Support from the DL team

2. Backend: Supabase vs. Firebase

Decision: Supabase (BaaS).

Option	Arguments
Supabase	Better cost tier (free for 50,000 active users!) PostgreSQL for geodata Relational Can later be self-hosted
Firebase	Known a little bit Google tooling

Source slides

User Interview Alex

Alex is very active in vr and makes intensive use of the vr WhatsApp Community for it.

Questions about the person

What is your life situation?

- 40 years old
- In a relationship
- Very active in various social groups for many years, mainly vr.
- Not actively looking for a partner, but open.

What do you do in your free time?

- Organizing events
- YouTube / Netflix
- Gym
- Meeting friends
- Going out to eat
- Sauna now and then
- Design now and then
- Dancing or DJing in clubs now and then
- Developing apps in phases
- Rarely hiking/excursions

Which region are you mainly active in?

- Rosenheim city
- Rarely outside, within a 50 km radius

Which locations or events by particular organizers do you visit regularly?

- Locations: Asta, Katzentempel
- Organizers: vr

Are you, or would you like to be, an event organizer yourself?

- I am

Are you, or would you like to be, politically/voluntarily active?

- A bit less at the moment, if you don't count vr

What keeps you from being more active?

- Too few participants / active people
- Commitment to planning
- Time required
- Lack of motivation

Can you think of anything that would help you become more active?

- Active people who join in
- Better tooling for planning
- Helpers
- A clear idea / goal

Questions about leisure activities in general

How do you find events & activities?

- Asta Instagram/website
- Shared in the vr community

How often do you go to events or activities?

- About once a week, rarely alone
- At least 1-2 times a week, up to 4 times a week

How do you feel when you find out you missed an interesting event?

- Sad
- Disappointed that I didn't look carefully enough

How much time do you invest in organizing your leisure time?

- About 30 min per week actively for activities
- Planning/organizing can take several hours

How often do you meet new people, and are you satisfied with that?

- 1-2 times per month, satisfied, but I miss the active people
- Maybe not much worse, but more unpleasant people are among them

What problems do you have getting to know new people?

- Unsure whether I'm annoying
- Generally don't dare to approach people unless I know for sure they are open to it right now
- I don't feel comfortable with some people

What would help you with organizing your leisure time?

- More ideas/offers from others
- Low-cost options

- Having the planning taken off my hands

What challenges do you have with organizing your leisure time?

- Planning / time required
- Unpleasant people or no good vibe
- Sometimes get attributed to the left-wing scene

What features would a leisure-time application need to have?

- As large a list of options as possible, but filterable
- Push notifications for especially interesting events
- See what my friends are doing
- Easy way to invite people
- Accepting guests

Do you see AI as possible support for organizing your leisure time?

- Suggestions
- Creating a plan for the event that I can follow step by step

What could put you off an application?

- AI slop / hallucinations / bad recommendations
- Being exposed to stalking

Which tools do you use to organize your leisure time?

- Largely the vr WhatsApp Community
- WhatsApp in general
- Instagram
- Very rarely Facebook
- Discord in the past

Questions about the current solution, the vr WhatsApp Community

How did you come to choose this solution?

- Wish for focused coordination by interest
- Widespread messenger (unlike Discord)
- Introduction of the Community feature

What do you use the application for?

- Meeting people

Where and when do you use the application?

- Spread throughout the day

Would you recommend the solution to people who want to meet new people?

- Yes, I also do so actively

What does your typical usage look like?

1. Idea
2. Ask about interest
3. Planning
4. Create event
5. Event organization / reservation / plan transport
6. Execution

Do you use it more actively or via notifications?

- Both, actively for my own ideas, passively for others'

What does successful usage look like for you?

- The experience took place

What do you expect from using it?

- Fulfilled: shared experiences, increasing vr's reach
- Unfulfilled: a large selection of leisure activities from others

What feelings does successful usage evoke in you?

- Relaxation, security
- Tension, excitement
- Intimacy, friendship

Have you had experiences through using it that you wouldn't have had otherwise?

- Yes, otherwise there wouldn't always be enough people

Which functions do you use regularly?

- Reactions
- Events
- New groups
- Polls

Which features come to mind that work really well?

- Events as an overview
- Polls
- Reactions
- Announcements

- Subgroup for planning

What doesn't work as desired?

- Cohesion of comments on events
- Old group messages for new users
- Spam
- Declining people you don't want to have there
- Group search

Which functions do you wish for?

- Sub-threads
- Old group messages always visible for new users
- Muting users
- Confirming event sign-ups
- Group search

What are the pros and cons of using it?

- Con: moderation effort
- Con: spam / getting annoyed
- Con: no real downtime
- Pro: best tool so far for organizing people
- Pro: all events are vegan

Which alternatives do you see or even use?

- Social media: Instagram, Facebook, Bluesky
- WhatsApp Channels
- Websites
- Online appointment planners

What would have to happen for you to switch?

- A solution that offers more features
- A solution that others also want to use
- A solution that will last in the long term

What new problems has using it created that you didn't have before?

- Moderation effort
- Spam / getting annoyed
- No real downtime
- Being exposed to people you don't click with

Have you ever thought about stopping using it? If so, why?

- No, only sometimes out of frustration, but there is no alternative

Do you wish for a completely different solution?

- Yes, an app that does exactly this and isn't used for anything else.

How do you rate social media in comparison?

- You occasionally find new people (but fewer than through the vr community)
- I only use it as a producer, not as a consumer
- Pro: hardly any moderation effort / spam
- Con: more effort to promote events
- Con: more effort to keep an overview of who is coming

Summary

Can you formulate in 1-2 sentences what you hope to get from using the app, without naming the app as the solution?

I want an app that lets me bring people together and get to know new people myself. I also want to have an impact on society, e.g. openness, creativity, veganism.

How would you describe your persona?

Alex, 40, wants to get to know new people and bring people together. He is primarily interested in the region around Rosenheim, wants to serve a good cause with it, and wants to be protected from unpleasant people. His current solution is WhatsApp; he is moderately satisfied with it but sees it as the best pragmatic option. He sees as a problem that people don't use the platform in a goal-driven way or mute groups (or don't participate for other reasons). An alternative would have to be easily accessible for everyone and last in the long term.

User Interview Juju

Juju is a regular visitor of the Asta pub in Rosenheim.

Questions about the person

How would you describe yourself as a target group?

- 24 years old
- Meets friends on weekends
- Organizes parties twice a year
- Meets new people now and then.
- In a relationship, open to new partners.

Which hobbies do you have, and which of them do you like to do in company?

- Choreographed dancing, alone
- Drinking coffee, sometimes in company
- Meeting friends
- Going to parties to dance, sometimes in company
- Going out to eat, only in company
- Gym, alone, at most with friends

Which region are you active in?

- Rosenheim city
- Munich

Which locations and organizers do you follow?

- Asta
- Vegans of Rosenheim
- Straight
- Katzentempel
- Cafe am Esbaum

Would you like to organize events more often?

- Would like to do more, once a month

Are you, or would you like to be, more active in volunteering, politics or activism?

- Is active in the Asta
- Would like to do more in all areas

What keeps you from doing more?

- Doesn't know where and how
- Is a bit worried about doing something wrong
- Unsure about the next steps
- Unsure which organizations exist

What would help you?

- Ideas for what one could do
- An explanation of what one would have to do

Questions about leisure activities

How do you find out what's going on?

- Instagram (Asta)
- People telling her
- vr WhatsApp Community

How often do you go to events or activities?

- Events every week
- Activities with others 2-3 times a week

Has it ever happened that you missed something?

- Has not happened

How often do you meet new people?

- 1 person per week

How much time do you put into planning your leisure time?

- 30 min per week
- Satisfied with that

What challenges are there, or what doesn't work well?

- Other people who don't have time
- Cancellations can be annoying
- The weather
- Unpleasant people / unpleasant atmosphere

Do you have problems approaching people?

- Has no problem approaching people as long as it wouldn't interrupt their conversation

What works well in organizing your leisure time?

- Asta events because of the atmosphere and the people (familiar people and a pleasant scene)
- Asta events because they offer the right kind of party

What would you wish for?

- More parties at the Asta

Remarks:

- No need for other solutions
- Asta is the primary driver of offerings
- After the Local Social Media concept was presented to her, however, she was interested in an event app

User Interview Kat

Kat is a user of the vr WhatsApp Community and the vr app.

Questions about using the WhatsApp Community

Why do you use the vr Community?

- For exchange, mostly topic groups
- Finding events
- Signing up for / cancelling events

When and where do you use the app?

- At home in the evening

What do you expect from it?

- Exchange of information
- Contact with people you like

Would you recommend the Community?

- Yes, if they are interested in veganism

How do you use the app?

- No push notifications
- Opens the app actively

What are the individual steps of your usage?

1. Remembers, has time
2. Browses the groups with new messages (mainly vr groups, can also be others)
3. Reads
4. Mostly without reacting
5. For an event, checks whether she can make it (via her appointment book)
6. Accepts, or "Maybe" if still unsure
7. Writes the appointment into her calendar book
8. If necessary, checks again whether anything has changed
9. Goes there

What feelings does the process evoke in you?

- Curiosity about what awaits you

- Anticipation of particular people
- Satisfaction with the steps

Does the Community work as desired?

- Yes

Are there experiences you wouldn't have otherwise?

- Not necessarily, would probably have used Instagram otherwise
- But a lot gets lost there

Which functions do you use?

- Accepting and declining (frequently)
- Food sharing, group orders, giving things away
- Emoji reactions (preferred over text)
- Replying to messages, but rarely

What pros and cons do you see?

- Con: information overload, masses of information pouring in
- Pro: going through the groups by interest and getting only the information you want
- Pro: moderation
- Con: moderation, people are unsure whether they are allowed to write, but are not experienced themselves
- Pro: sharing things yourself, actively shaping, exchange

What new problems has the Community created?

- Noticed problems at events with certain people, but it did not influence her negatively.
- Probably less information overload, but more from other sources (so not really a problem either)

What could be improved?

- Traunstein area (new community)
- More clarity than communities that have to be linked with communities
- Group limits could be annoying when you hit the limit and then have to decide what is worth more

Which alternatives do you see?

- Instagram
- Signal / Threema / WhatsApp in general

What would have to happen for you to switch to an alternative?

- Implement the group solution somehow
- Enable exchange

Have you ever wanted to leave the Community, or do you wish for a completely different solution?

- No

Questions about the person

How would you describe yourself as a target group?

- "I want to be able to connect with people who have a similar mindset, both for leisure exchange and activism"
- 33 years old
- Socially active depending on the day's form and energy level.
- Would also be happy alone in the outback, can do both, has to be careful that it doesn't get too much
- Life situation steady, partly happy
- Social situation is absolutely satisfactory
- Has a partner, not looking for a partner
- Is active in Traunstein and Rosenheim

What are your hobbies, and which of them do you like to do in company?

- Work, osteopathy, gladly in company
- Gaming, would also do it alone, but mostly in company, guild, RPG, digital
- Swimming, gladly in company
- Martial arts, together with others
- Dancing in clubs, used to go alone, now unfortunately in company because of less time to go alone
- Partner dancing, in company
- Painting and crafting, but only alone

Which locations and organizers do you follow?

- Katzentempel
- vr
- Asta with mixed feelings
- Summerbreeze/Feuertanz
- Intermediary: Rosenheim24
- The pizzeria around the corner

Are you, or would you like to be, an event organizer?

- Yes, already active to a limited extent
- Would like to do more, especially in the Traunstein area.

Are you, or would you like to be, more active in volunteering?

- Is active
- Would like to be more

What keeps you from it?

- Time because of job and side job
- Emotional capacity
- Fear of not doing it properly, perfectionism, puts herself under pressure
- Lack of knowledge, uncertainty whether it works like this

What could help with that?

Exchange with, or even help from, other event organizers

Questions about leisure activities in general

How do you find events?

- vr Community
- Instagram
- Radio

How often do you go to events or activities?

- 2-5 times a month to events
- 2-3 times a week activities

Have you ever missed an event?

- Yes, definitely was annoyed, but not very often

How much time do you invest in organizing your leisure time?

- Varies so much, can go towards 0
- But can also require several days of coordination
- Sometimes unnecessarily complicated

How often do you meet new people?

- At most once a month

Do you have inhibitions about approaching new people?

- Yes
- The person could be unpleasant
- Could be unpleasant for others
- Not knowing what to talk about
- Waiting for the right moment

What would help with planning your leisure time?

- Support from others
- Guideline
- Inspiration

- Quick overview to find events, 5 min would be a good amount (added later)

What are the biggest challenges?

- Overlapping appointments for yourself and others
- Always finding time / commitment
- Uncertainty about which people will come
- Many ideas but others' lack of interest in joining

What works well and what works badly?

- Good: vr events, also organizing them herself, has worked well
- Good: reliability of events
- Bad: coordination often doesn't work so well
- Bad: commitment is missing, people suddenly cancel
- Good: event organizers decide who is there

Summary

What would you wish for, without naming a concrete solution?

- "I hope for a time-efficient collection of information and exchange with others, and for finding activities I can take part in."

Which features are important to you for organizing leisure time?

- Accept/decline for commitment
- Asking about safety needs
- Exchange with others
- A contact person for moderation

What would put you off an app that fulfills this?

- New people
- Already has a solution (vr Community)
- But without vr, a quick chance,
- Instant advertising, any kind of advertising is off-putting
- Weird vibe with people

What would an alternative have to do?

- vr uses it
- or vr drops out as an alternative

Remarks:

- Doesn't get along with Google Calendar, too cluttered
- Generally prefers a fixed circle over constantly new people
- A solution with a user limit would not put her off, she would also be happy with few users

User Interview Rick

Rick is a user of the vr WhatsApp Community and the vr app.

Questions about the current solution as a vr Community user

Why do you use the vr Community?

- Arranging meetups
- Seeing what is being written
- Spontaneous meetups
- Moderating

Where and when do you use the Community?

- Regularly throughout the day.
- Rather at home, often ignored when out and about

What do you expect from using the Community?

- Meeting new people (at events)

Would you recommend the Community to people who want to meet new people?

- Rather the events in the Community than the Community itself

What does your typical usage of the Community look like?

1. Notification
2. Reading
3. If necessary, reaction or acceptance

Do you use the Community more actively or via notifications?

- Rather via notifications

What does successful usage of the Community look like for you?

- Finding a date / successful planning
- Using one of the topic groups, e.g. swapping/giving away things

What feelings does successful usage evoke in you?

- Feelings of happiness
- Anticipation

Have you had experiences through using it that you wouldn't have had otherwise?

- Yes, picnics and spontaneous meetups
- 70% of leisure activities via the app or its events

Which functions do you use regularly?

- Event groups
- Actually every kind of group
- Emoji reactions (to minimize notifications)

Which features come to mind that work really well?

- Topic groups

Which functions do you wish for?

- Sub-threads, focus on one topic, so there is no spam and cohesion becomes possible
- Overview of events
- No phone number needed anymore, anonymity (already announced)
- A personal assistant for organizing an event would also be good.

What are the pros and cons of using it?

- Many groups, pro: not annoyed by other topics
- Many groups, con: you have to get familiar / get an overview
- Con: WhatsApp / data protection
- Pro: moderation to avoid spam.

Which alternatives do you see or even use?

- Other Instagram providers: RosenheimWasGeht, AroundRosenheim, RosenheimErleben
- Following locations via social media (e.g. Tony's)
- Checking a website (e.g. Asta)
- vr app
- Posters in the city center (but only if there is no digital solution; prefers digital)

What would have to happen for you to switch?

- A new primary source for vr events, e.g. through a chat function in the vr app

What new problems has using the Community created that you didn't have before?

- Spam
- Many more messages
- Many groups

What doesn't work as desired?

- The wrong people react
- People simply join meetups, everyone can read along, no security

Have you already thought about leaving the Community or uninstalling WhatsApp?

- No, but spam could drive him to leave groups

Do you wish for a different solution?

- No, only smaller feature wishes.

How do you rate the alternative of a simple event list?

- Uses these solutions for meeting people
- Used proactively (rarely)
- Con: you can't enter anything yourself
- Con: no interaction possible

Questions about the person

What is your life situation?

- 29 years old
- In a relationship
- Very active because of his volunteer work, but used to have less contact with other people.
- Currently looking for a partner

What do you do in your free time?

- Sauna
- Bouldering
- Sports/gym
- Lake
- Going out to eat, restaurants & bars

Which region are you mainly active in?

- Primarily in Rosenheim
- Occasionally in cities nearby
- Occasionally Munich
- Max. 100 km radius around home

Which locations or events by particular organizers do you visit regularly?

- Locations: Asta, Vettern, Pirate, I'm Irish, Irish Pub, saunas.
- Organizers: vr, WV, City Management

Are you, or would you like to be, an event organizer yourself?

- Would like to be / is planned (political regulars' table)

Are you, or would you like to be, politically/voluntarily active?

- Active in volunteering and politics, but would like to be more active.

What keeps you from being more active?

- It's a lot of work / time required
- Hard to muster motivation
- Establishing capacity/focus in his head
- Only feels like it in bursts

Can you think of anything that would help you become more active?

- Easy access to gather information or ideas

Questions about leisure activities in general

How do you find events & activities?

- vr app, vr Community, Instagram, Asta website, friends

How often do you go to events or activities?

- 1-2 times a week to events, very rarely alone.
- 3-4 times a week activities.

How do you feel when you find out you missed an interesting event?

- No very negative feelings when an event is missed, "a bit annoying"

How much time do you invest in organizing your leisure time?

- 30 min per week.
- At most 15 min per day.
- But mostly passive.

How often do you meet new people, and are you satisfied with that?

- Twice a month
- That's fine.
- But through the vr WhatsApp Community.

What problems do you have getting to know new people?

- Has problems approaching new people at events, because you don't want to be a burden to anyone.
- A signal making clear that you want to be approached would help.

What would help you with organizing your leisure time?

- More quick suggestions.
- Good weather.
- The right people.

What challenges do you have with organizing your leisure time?

- People join whom you don't feel like seeing
- Event too far away / hard to reach
- Too many people
- Possibly nobody is there
- Lack of ideas for what to do
- Weighing whether it is intrinsic or you just go along with it
- Finding out your needs and listening to them. A bit of time would also be okay to find out what you feel like doing (too much AI would not be good there at all).
- More planning than progress / no decision-making
- Migrantization (added later)

Do you see AI as possible support for organizing your leisure time?

- See above, for organization
- See above, for event discovery, but with skepticism

What features would a leisure-time application need to have?

- Messenger with threads (note: event- & topic-related messages)
- Individual planning
- Overview of events

What could put you off an application?

- AI slop
- Bad ratings
- Bad marketing
- Few users (> 1000 would be a good number for an app specifically for Rosenheim)
- Outdated content (no current entries, i.e. older than 2 days)
- Costs would be off-putting
- Aggressive in-app advertising

Summary

Can you formulate in 1-2 sentences what you hope to get from using the app, without naming the app as the solution?

I wish for an app that connects people simply and without complication, so that I can broaden my horizons, satisfy my need for fun and connection, and so that bridges are built across society and people come together again.

How would you describe your persona?

Rick, 29 years old, wants to meet new and familiar people in a simple way. He also does this to broaden his horizons. He is careful when choosing events because of potential migrantization. Rick currently mainly uses the vr WhatsApp Community to keep up with vr activities and is satisfied with it. He would use a different solution if vr used it as its primary event provider.

Additional information (added later)

- Is attributed a migration background (migrantization) and is therefore careful when choosing events. Does not want to be exposed to regulars'-table slogans, for example.
- Wants bridges to be built across society and people to come together again (currently feels it has been unlearned).

User Interview Veronika

Veronika is a user of the vr WhatsApp Community and the vr app.

Questions about the current solution [application/tool]

Why do you use the vr Community?

- To take part in events

What do you expect from taking part in events?

- Exchange with other people
- Sense of belonging
- New perspectives
- Social contacts

Which alternatives do you see?

- Initially none
- When asked: existing circle of friends (but a large part of it is also from the Community)
- Arrangements outside the vr Community, mainly via WhatsApp/Signal

Where and when do you use the Community?

- Spread throughout the day
- At home and on the go
- But mainly when alone

Do you recommend the Community to friends or acquaintances?

- Yes, has already happened

Do you use the app more actively or via push notifications?

- Rather via notifications

What does the usage look like in individual steps?

1. Tap the notification
2. Accept in the event
3. Save to calendar -> via the vr app
4. If necessary, remind/inform friends
5. Ready for the event

How do you perceive this process?

- Used to it
- No frustration regarding WhatsApp's problems with events
- Triggers anticipation for the event

Were there experiences with the Community that you wouldn't have had otherwise?

- Yes, regular events once a week, and
- 3 hours per week of the remaining leisure activities would have been lost.

Which functions do you use most?

- Invitations to events
- Swap and give-away group
- Looking up phone numbers to get in contact
- Reactions
- Reply function, but generally writes little
- Rarely uses the chat, would like to more

Why would you like to chat more?

- To organize more things herself

Does the Community work as desired?

- Yes, the Community does
- Events cannot be added to the calendar with work profiles (WhatsApp bug)

What are the pros and cons of using it?

- Pro: social contact
- Pro: easy organization
- Pro: finds everything you need
- Con: spam (within limits)
- Con: you don't go to an event because another person is coming whom you want to avoid
- But also a pro: you see who is coming
- Pro: reliability when accepting and declining

Do you have improvement wishes?

- See a group's description more clearly and quickly
- Threads, so that messages are connected

What alternatives do you have?

- Signal
- Meetup (business), didn't dare to use it for leisure
- Instagram

How important is data protection?

- Quite important
- Concerns if third parties also receive anonymized data
- Handing over data should be opt-in

What would have to happen for you to switch to an alternative?

- Signal, if a Community function exists
- Instagram with suitable chat channels, but prefers WhatsApp / because of end-to-end encryption

Are there new problems that you didn't have before?

- Problems through new social contacts / uncertainties

Have you ever wanted to leave, or wished for a completely different solution?

- No

Questions about the person

How would you describe yourself as a target group?

- Technician, 27, creative, wanted to build a new circle of friends.
- Back then less socially active, but by now yes.
- Life situation in transition
- Active in Rosenheim, the surrounding area, Munich, up to 1.5 hours of travel, likes driving.
- No relationship, not looking for a partner.

What are your hobbies, and which of them do you like to do with others?

- Sewing, tinkering with the sewing machine, alone
- Piano, guitar, alone
- Meeting friends / meeting new people
- Walking, gladly in company
- Video games, gladly in company
- Climbing, bouldering (only via an offer)
- Hiking (only via an offer)

Are there organizers you follow?

- Tony's, Katzentempel, Tom&Mäx
- A bit of Asta
- vr
- Intermediary: RosenheimWasGeht (via Instagram)

Are you, or would you like to be, more active in organizing?

- Yes (even if it is scary), has already organized

Are you, or would you like to be, active in volunteering/politics?

- Would like to be

What keeps you from it?

- Connection / people to team up with
- Ideas
- Fear of being overwhelmed
- Fear of doing it wrong

Can you think of anything that could make it easier?

- Exchange with event organizers

Questions about leisure activities in general

How do you find out what's going on?

- Groups in the vr Community
- Note: uses the vr app to show events

How often do you go to events or take part in activities?

- 2 to 3 times a month to events
- Several times a week activities

Has it happened that you missed something? What feelings does that trigger?

- Doesn't happen often
- Sadness
- Depending on the situation, maybe also an attempt not to let it happen again

How much time do you invest in organizing your leisure time?

- Coordination spread throughout the day
- About 4 h per week
- A lot of "back and forth" makes coordinating more laborious
- Overall, it could take a bit less time

How often do you meet new people?

- 1-2 per month
- Mainly from the vr environment

What would help with planning?

- No ideas what would help, also wants to be spontaneous
- Accepts it as it is

Do you have problems approaching people?

- Yes, inhibitions about approaching people
- The vr Community lowers the inhibitions

What is working really well in your leisure time at the moment?

- People you like to meet regularly
- Choice of people
- Dares to go to events alone (with exceptions)
- The event process with the vr Community

What doesn't work?

- Finding the people from the event is occasionally challenging

Summary

What would a solution for organizing leisure time have to look like, without naming a concrete solution?

- "I wish to have an overview of events and not be spammed while discovering events, but still have the possibility to exchange with others."

What could put you off such a solution?

- Inhibitions about writing in groups
- Too few downloads, should exceed a fixed group size, 100+ for sure
- Any price, or too restricted in the free version
- Intrusive advertising
- Serif font / branding
- Inactivity

Which features would you wish for?

- Overview of events, filterable by event type, including e.g. small events
- Detailed FAQ

Value Proposition Canvas

Customer Segment

Customer Job(s)

Job	Type
Find activities or events	Functional
Organize own activities or events	Functional
Find participants for own events	Functional
Meeting people	Social
Build connections	Social
Control participants	Social
Feeling of belonging	Emotional

Gains

- Building self-confidence
- Exciting / fun / meaningful moments
- Creating friendships
- Overview of events and activities
- Be more creative with free-time
- Flexibility with larger social circle
- Control about encounters
- Being in company
- Feeling welcome
- Get to know new people
- Find enough participants
- Contribution & impact
- Organise successful events

Pains

- Loneliness / isolation
- Unhappy with current people / bubble
- Boredom
- Not knowing what to do
- Safety risks like stalking
- Social insecurity to talk to new people
- Alone at events
- Events missed

- Unpleasant encounters
- Complicated activity arrangement
- Search frustration for activities
- High effort finding people
- Overwhelmed by organisation

Value Proposition

Products & Services

- Event & activity feed
- Event & activity notification
- Event & activity recommendation
- Event & activity creation
- Participant control
- Friend invitation
- User management (Friending / blocking)

Gain Creators

- Quick event overview
- Friend-requests to stay in touch
- People network
- Event recommendation to find new activities
- Knowing of open space where you can talk to new people
- Event drafting to collect ideas
- Putting organisers in control of participants
- Promote activities as open for all by default
- Provide identification marks to find right group
- Get to know new people by shared activity interest
- Easy event creation
- See NGOs / activism events
- Invite friends to events

Pain Relievers

- Open activities to meet new people
- Invite friends to have company and reduce social insecurity
- Block unwanted users
- Participant control to avoid unwanted guests
- Transparency about participants
- Reminder and invitation notification, so that events are not missed
- Bookmark activity or save to calendar
- Follow tag/host to avoid missing events
- Filter and recommendation to find best activities
- Easy filtering by categories to get suggestions
- Show what's happening now for spontaneous activities

- Suggest to join other activities when creating a similar activity to prevent low participation
- Simple event creation/drafting with smart defaults to encourage planning
- Simple activity creation, also for events, to find people to go together
- Activity-first to prevent complicated arrangements
